

Meta App Creation (Messenger Automation)

Promise School Facebook Messenger auto-reply setup — Meta Developer app creation, permissions, and credentials only.

Focused guide for creating the Meta Developer app and collecting credentials. Webhook registration, n8n deploy, and go-Live steps are separate — see `docs/meta-setup.md` after this.

1. Create the app

- 1. Open [Meta for Developers](#) → **Create App**.
 - 2. Select **Other** → **Business** (or any use case that exposes Messenger).
 - 3. Name the app (e.g. `Promise School Messenger`).
 - 4. Link it to your Business Portfolio if prompted (optional but recommended for org apps).
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2. Add required products

In the app dashboard, click **Add Product** and enable:

Product	Purpose
Messenger	Connect your Facebook Page and generate a Page Access Token for sending/receiving DMs
Webhooks	Subscribe to incoming Messenger events (configured later against your n8n URL)

3. Permissions

These are the permissions this setup needs. Request or grant them when generating tokens in Graph API Explorer or during App Review.

Required for token generation (Development)

When getting a User Access Token in [Graph API Explorer](#), select:

Permission	Access level	Why
pages_messaging	Standard (dev) / Advanced (Live)	Send and receive Messenger messages via Graph API (POST /me/messages)
pages_manage_metadata	Standard	Subscribe the Page to your app and manage webhook metadata
pages_show_list	Standard	List Pages you manage so you can select the correct Page token

pages_messaging is the critical one. Without it, Mark Seen, typing indicators, and reply sends will fail.

For going Live (later)

In **App Review** → **Permissions and Features**, request **Advanced Access** for:

- **pages_messaging** — required so non-app-role customers (any Messenger user) receive bot replies

Supporting permissions (`pages_manage_metadata` , `pages_show_list`) usually stay at Standard Access. See `docs/app-review.md` when ready.

Development vs Live

App mode	Who the bot can reply to
Development	App admins, developers, testers, and Page roles only
Live + Advanced Access on <code>pages_messaging</code>	All Messenger users

4. Connect your Facebook Page

1. Go to **Messenger** → **Settings**.
2. Click **Add or Remove Pages**.
3. Connect the Promise School Page using a Facebook account that has the **MESSAGING** task on that Page.

4. Under **Token Generation**, select your Page → click **Generate** → copy the **Page Access Token**.

To get a **long-lived** token (recommended):

1. [Graph API Explorer](#) → select your app.
2. **Get User Access Token** → add the three permissions above.
3. **Get Page Access Token** → select your Page.
4. Extend the token via [Access Token Debugger](#) if it is short-lived.

5. Collect credentials for `.env`

From the Meta console, copy these values into `messenger-automation/.env`:

```
# App settings → Basic
META_APP_ID=<your-app-id>
META_APP_SECRET=<your-app-secret>

# Messenger → Settings → Token Generation
META_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN=<long-lived-page-token>
META_PAGE_ID=<your-page-id>

# Pick any random secret string (same value used later in Webhooks → Verify Token)
META_VERIFY_TOKEN=<random-secret-string>

META_GRAPH_API_VERSION=v22.0
```

- **App ID + App Secret** — used by `./scripts/setup-meta.sh` to auto-subscribe webhook fields.
- **Page Access Token** — used by n8n to call `https://graph.facebook.com/v22.0/me/messages`.
- **Page ID** — identifies which Page receives webhooks.
- **Verify token** — shared secret for Meta webhook verification (not the Page ID or Page token).

Never commit tokens to git. Store secrets only in `.env` on the VPS.

6. Add testers (Development mode)

While the app stays in **Development**:

1. Go to **App Roles** → **Roles**.
2. Add your personal Facebook account as **Administrator**, **Developer**, or **Tester**.

3. Only people with these roles (plus Page roles) will receive bot replies until the app goes Live.

Checklist (Meta app only)

- ☐ Meta app created (**Other** → **Business**)
- ☐ **Messenger** and **Webhooks** products added
- ☐ **App ID** and **App Secret** copied
- ☐ Facebook Page connected under Messenger → Settings
- ☐ Page Access Token generated with `pages_messaging`, `pages_manage_metadata`, `pages_show_list`
- ☐ Token extended to long-lived
- ☐ `META_PAGE_ID`, `META_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN`, `META_VERIFY_TOKEN` saved in `.env`
- ☐ Testers added under App Roles (for dev-mode DMs)

Next steps (outside this guide): deploy n8n, register webhook callback URL, subscribe Page to `messages` + `messaging_postbacks` — see `docs/meta-setup.md`.